

The Data Layer

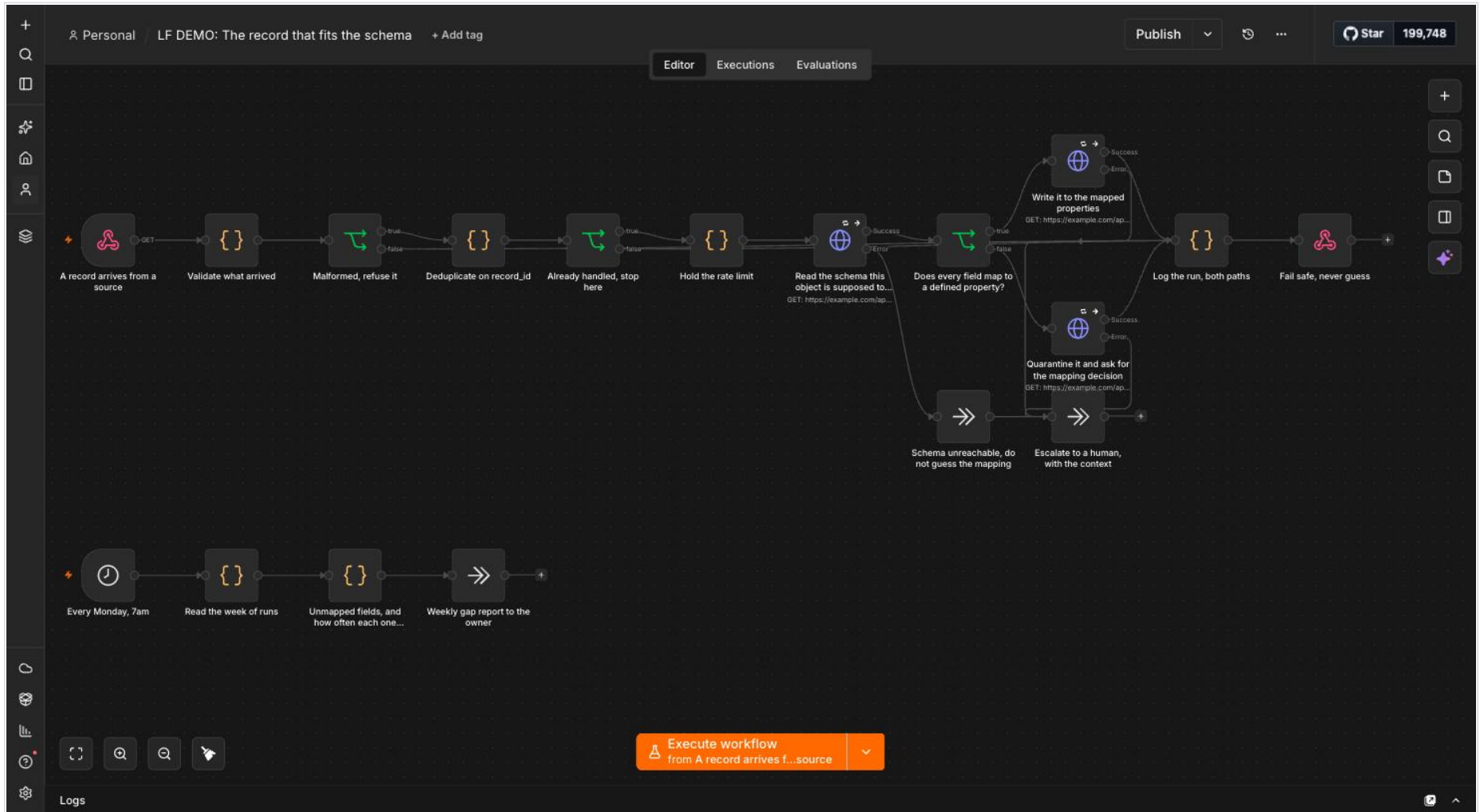
data-model-architecture · built in airtable

Most CRM problems are data-model problems wearing a workflow costume.

What it connects to: The schema has to hold for every system that writes into it. A property that only makes sense in one tool is the one that breaks the reporting later.

1 of 4 SYSTEM

Here's the system that enforces it — a record only gets written once every field maps to a property that exists.



2 of 4 THINKING

This is the gate that keeps the model clean: every field has to map to a property that exists, or the record is quarantined rather than guessed at. Guessing is how you end up with three fields meaning the same thing.

The screenshot shows a dark-themed user interface for a data processing tool. The main window is titled "Does every field map to a defined property?". The interface is divided into two main sections: "INPUT" on the left and "Parameters" / "Settings" on the right.

INPUT Section:

- At the top, it says "INPUT".
- Below that, there is a large area with the text "No input data" and a button "Execute previous nodes" with the subtitle "to view input data".
- On the far left, there is a vertical sidebar with various icons, including a globe icon.

Parameters / Settings Section:

- At the top right, there is an orange button labeled "Execute step".
- Below the button, there are two tabs: "Parameters" (selected) and "Settings".
- Under the "Parameters" tab, there is a section titled "Conditions".
- Inside the "Conditions" section, there is a text area containing the following code:

```
{{ $json.fullyMapped === true && $json.objectExists === true }}
```
- To the right of the text area, there is a checkbox labeled "is true" which is checked.
- Below the text area, there is a button labeled "+ Add condition".
- Below the "Conditions" section, there is a toggle switch labeled "Convert types where required" which is currently turned off.
- Below the toggle switch, there is a section titled "Options" with a button labeled "+ Add option".

Here's the object model on a real portal — objects, properties, and how they associate.

SAMPLE - CRM to Ops Bridge

Data

Automations

Interfaces

Forms

Launch

Share

Deals (from CRM)

Delivery Projects

Sync Log

+ Add or import

Tools

Grid view

Hide fields

Filter

Group

Sort

Color

Team

Share and sync

+ Create new...

Find a view

Grid view

	Project	Linked Deal	Phase	Due	Owner
1	Northwind Trading - Port...				PM Delta
2	Cedar & Co - Ops Migrati...				PM Echo
3	Halberd Systems - CRM ...				PM Delta
4	Ironvale Dental - Intake A...				PM Foxtrot
5	Bluepeak Logistics - Disp...				PM Echo
6	Vantage Orthodontics - O...				PM Foxtrot
7	Quill & Sparrow - Proposa...				PM Delta
8	Redstone Plumbing - Job ...				PM Echo
+					

Linked Deal

Link to Deals (from CRM)

Link to records in the Deals (from CRM) table.

General

Allow linking to multiple records

Show display name instead of primary field

Advanced

Limit record selection to a view

Filter record selection by a condition

Use AI to show top matches when selecting a record

+ Add description

Cancel

Save

Automate this field with an agent

Convert

To select columns that aren't adjacent to each other, hold **⌘** and click.

DISMISS

8 deliveries

And the property architecture underneath it, with fill rates so you can see what's actually used.

SAMPLE - Cleaner Performance System

DATA

Automations

Interfaces

Forms

Cleaners

Clients

Incidents

+

Add or import

Grid view

Hide fields

Filter

Group

Sort

Color

Team

Share and sync

+ Create new...

Find a view

Grid view

Incident ID	Excused?	Date
1	1	
2	2	
3	3	
+		

3 records

Sum 6

Cleaner

Link to Cleaners

Link to records in the Cleaners table.

General

Allow linking to multiple records

Show display name instead of primary field

Advanced

Limit record selection to a view

Filter record selection by a condition

Use AI to show top matches when selecting a record

+ Add description

Cancel

Create

Automate this field with an agent

Convert